PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, February 18, 2025

Special Meeting and Work Session

Meeting Minutes

(Draft)

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Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Special Meeting and Work Session of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Director Julia Brim-Edwards: Present, Director Michelle DePass: Present, Director Herman Greene: Present, Director Gary Hollands: Present, Director Christy Splitt: Present, Director Patte Sullivan: Present, Director Edward Wang: Present. Present. Student Representative JJ Kunsevi: Present.

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 6:45 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Consent Agenda (Resolutions 7045-7049)

Time: 6:48 pm

There was discussion regarding the international field trip included in Resolution 7046, including its duration, criteria for exceptions, cost and funding sources, and ensuring continued learning for non-traveling students. There was a request to include the criteria for an exception to trip duration in the Administrative Directive, as well as an update on the status of implementing an 8th-grade capstone activity.

Actions:

Director Michelle DePass moved and Director Patte Sullivan seconded the motion to adopt the Consent Agenda, including resolutions 7045 through 7049. Motion was put to a voice vote and passed (7 yes – 0 no).

Directors Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Yes, Wang: Yes; Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Annual Multnomah Education Service District Local Service Plan Resolution (Resolution 7052)

Time: 7:01 pm

Sascha Perrins – Multnomah Education Service District (MESD) Assistant Superintendent

It was noted that the list of services available for use from the Multnomah Education Service District (MESD) are options available to Portland Public Schools (PPS) and that the district may not choose to utilize all the services available. There was discussion regarding outdoor school being scheduled in the current year during religious and cultural holidays, which is in violation of the Religious and Cultural Observances Policy 2.30.010-P. The MESD representative highlighted the complexities in the scheduling of outdoor school, noting that principal's have the option to request dates and indicates dates that don't work for them. The Superintendent and MESD affirmed they would work together to minimize scheduling conflicts with religious and cultural holidays. There was discussion regarding the enforcement of Policy 2.30.010-P.

Public Comment:

- Ariel Matasar: Urged the Board to enforce its policy on protected dates, noting their child missed part of Outdoor School due to scheduling on Rosh Hashanah, which privileged non-Jewish students.
- Mel Berwin: Urged the Board to enforce its holiday equity policy and ensure compliance from district partners.

Actions:

Director Herman Greene moved and Director Michelle DePass seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7052, Annual Multnomah Education Service District Local Service Plan Resolution. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (7 yes – 0 no).

Directors Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Yes, Wang: Yes; Student Representative JJ Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Resolution to Approve the 2025-26 School District Calendar (Resolution 7050)

Time: 7:33 pm

It was noted that the calendar was presented at the previous meeting. There was no Board discussion.

Public Comment:

- Dr. Bahia Overton: Emphasized the urgency of launching the Center for Black Excellence, noting that it requires more than funding and that community leaders are prepared to move forward.
- Kali Thorne Ladd: Now is the time to move forward with the Center for Black Excellence, as community leaders are ready. The Board was urged to consider the future while planning.

Actions:

Director Patte Sullivan moved and Director Christy Splitt seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7050, Resolution to Approve the 2025-26 School District Calendar. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (7 yes – 0 no).

Directors Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Yes, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Yes, Wang: Yes; Student Representative Kunsevi, Yes (unofficial) Student Representative JJ Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Vision for Special Education Services in Portland Public Schools

Time: 7:41 pm

Chief of Student Supports - Jey Buno

Staff presented an overview of PPS's Vision for Special Education, including strategic goals such as integration into neighborhood schools, student representation in Special Education, academic data, and Special Education funding. Staff noted that while academic achievement data is not where they want it to be, PPS is performing better than the state average. Key priorities include reengaging families, professional learning for educators, and strengthening core programming. Board members asked questions throughout the presentation. There was Board discussion regarding the rates of representation of students of color, the need for additional administrative support in schools with high special education enrollment, the supports in place during the transition to neighborhood schools and how those supports were communicated to the community, the increasing need for special education services, and the need for advocacy at the state level, particularly regarding funding caps. Staff outlined the next steps, including further engagement with advisory committees and community input to shape future actions. Legislative efforts to increase special education funding were also highlighted.

Update: 2025 General Obligation Bond

Time: 7:58 pm

An update on the 2025 general obligation bond was provided, noting that the board has established parameters for reducing high school modernization costs, design advisory committees have resumed their work, and the Climate Crisis Response Committee (CCRC) has expressed support for full electrification of the new schools. A consultant and campaign manager have been hired, a website is in development (yespdx.com), and student engagement underway for the campaign. The referral paperwork will be submitted soon.

Adjourn

Chair Eddie Wang adjourned the meeting at 9:01 pm.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools

Resolutions As Adopted

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RESOLUTION No. 7045

Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts and approve payment for products, materials, supplies, capital outlay, equipment, and services whenever the total amount exceeds $150,000 per contract, excepting settlement or real property agreements. Contracts meeting this criterion are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the Deputy Clerk to enter into the following agreements.

NEW CONTRACTS

No New Contracts

Contractor	Contract Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Contract Amount	Responsible Admin, Funding Source	Certified Business
Optimum Foods LLC	2/19/25 through 2/18/26 Option to renew for up to four additional one-year terms through 2/18/30	Materials Requirement MR 96169	Provide shelf stable emergency meals to PPS Nutrition Services Request for Proposals 2024-036	Original Term: $75,000 Total through all renewals: $375,000	D. Jung Fund 202 Dept. 5570	No
Bake Crafters Food Company	2/19/25 through 2/18/26 Option to renew for up to four additional one-year terms through 2/18/30	Materials Requirement MR 96167	Provide ready to serve entrees to PPS Nutrition Services Request for Proposals 2024-036	Original Term: $800,000 Total through all renewals: $4,000,000	D. Jung Fund 202 Dept. 5570	No
Diversified Foods, Inc.	2/19/25 through 2/18/26 Option to renew for up to four additional one-year terms through 2/18/30	Materials Requirement MR 96168	Provide shelf stable milk to PPS Nutrition Services Request for Proposals 2024-036	Original Term: $170,000 Total through all renewals: $850,000	D. Jung Fund 202 Dept. 5570	No
Roadrunner Pizza / Batish Home Bake LLC	2/19/25 through 2/18/26 Option to renew for up to four additional one-year terms through 2/18/30	Materials Requirement MR 96170	Provide pizza topped with USDA cheese to PPS Nutrition Services Request for Proposals 2024-036	Original Term: $450,000 Total through all renewals: $2,250,000	D. Jung Fund 202 Dept. 5570	No
Tasty Brands	2/19/25 through 2/18/26 Option to renew for up to four additional one-year terms through 2/18/30	Materials Requirement MR 96171	Provide ready to bake breadsticks filled with USDA cheese to PPS Nutrition Services Request for Proposals 2024-036	Original Term: $240,000 Total through all renewals: $1,200,000	D. Jung Fund 202 Dept. 5570	No
Wilson Language Training Corp	2/19/25	Purchase Order PO 171024	Purchase of Foundations reading curriculum. Special Class Procurement – Copyrighted Materials and Creative Works PPS-47-0288 (4)	$323,750	K. Howard Fund 251 Dept. 5467 Grant G2365	No

*A Certified Business is a for-profit business certified as a Minority-Owned Businesses (MBE), Women-Owned Businesses (WBE), Emerging Small Businesses (ESB), and/or Service-Disabled Veteran Businesses (SDV) by the State of Oregon Certification Office for Business Inclusion and Diversity.

NEW COOPERATIVE PURCHASING AGREEMENTS

No New Cooperative Purchasing Agreements

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS (“IGAs”)

No New IGAs

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

No New Amendments

RESOLUTION No. 7046

Authorization for Off-Campus Activities

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Policy 6.50.010-P ("Off-Campus Activities") requires the Board of Education ("Board") consent to student out-of-state travel.

RESOLUTION

The Board has reviewed the request for out-of-state travel. All required documents have been submitted to the Risk Management Department. The Superintendent recommends that the Board consent to the student out-of-state travel for the below request:

AUTHORIZATION FOR OFF-CAMPUS ACTIVITIES

Date(s)	School, Course, & Number of Students	Purpose of Travel	Travel Destination	Estimated Cost	Equitable Field Trip Fund; %
3/3-3/14/25	Cleveland HS Mandarin, 29	Visit sister school, speak with local people to enhance & apply what's been learned	Taiwan	$1700	N/A
4/10/2025	Wells HS AVID, 40	College tour	Seattle, WA	$79	N/A
4/24-4/27/25	Grant Magazine, 24	National Journalism Conference	Seattle, WA	$500	N/A

RESOLUTION No. 7047

Adoption of the Minutes

The Following Minutes are offered for Adoption:

- February 04, 2025 – Regular Meeting

RESOLUTION No. 7048

Approving Board Member Conference Attendance as Representatives of the Board

RECITALS

Board Policy 1.40.070 requires Board approval for individual Board members to attend state or national meetings as representatives of the Board.

RESOLUTION

The Board affirms Director Gary Hollands and Director Herman Greene to attend the National Conference on Education Conference in New Orleans, LA from March 6 -8, 2025.

RESOLUTION No. 7049

Approving Board Member Attendance in a Leadership Academy

RECITALS

Board Policy 1.40.070 requires Board approval for individual Board members to attend state or national meetings as representatives of the Board.

RESOLUTION

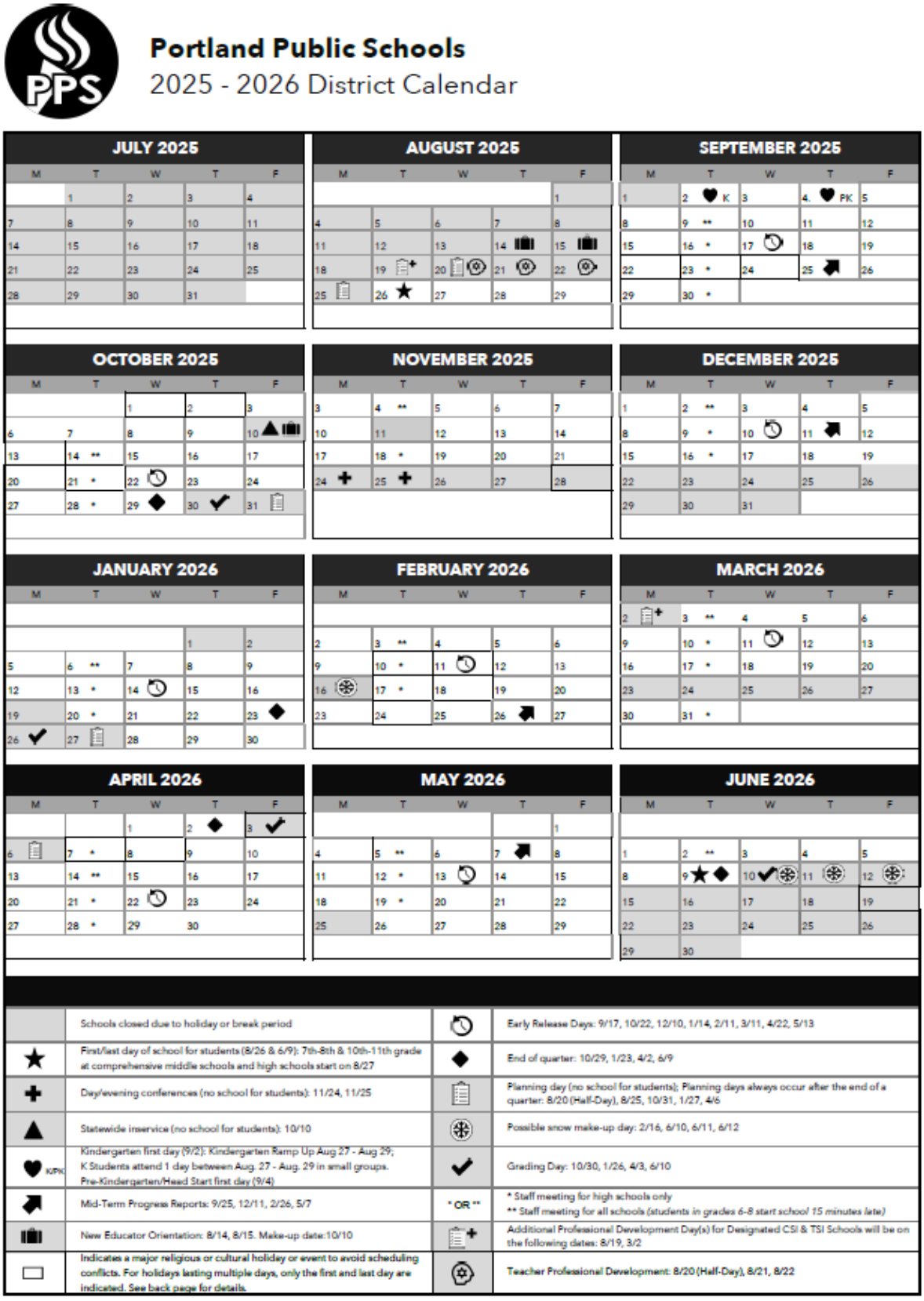
The Board affirms Vice-Chair Michelle DePass to attend the National School Board Association Leadership Academy in Washington D.C. from February 22-23, 2025, April 25-26, 2025, and May 23-24, 2025.

RESOLUTION No. 7050

Resolution to Approve the 2025-26 School District Calendar

RESOLUTION

The Board of Education hereby adopts the 2025-263 School District Calendar.



Major Religious Holidays and Cultural Events 2025-26	
Schools work to avoid scheduling special school events on major religious holidays and cultural events to be inclusive of all students. This includes the scheduling of field trips, back-to-school night, outdoor school, assemblies, major tests, PTA and site council meetings, student performances, etc. This list of holidays/events does not include all students' traditions and there may be other dates to avoid scheduling conflicts for students.	
Sep. 22 - 24 Rosh Hashanah*	Feb. 14 Ash Wednesday
Oct. 1-2 Yom Kippur*	Feb. 17 - Mar. 18 Ramadan*
Oct. 13 Indigenous Peoples' Day	Apr. 3 Good Friday
Oct. 21 Diwali	Apr. 5 Easter
Nov. 28 Native American Heritage Day	Mar. 19 - 22 Eid al-Fitr*
Dec. 14 - 22 Hanukkah*	April 12-20 Passover*
Dec. 25 Christmas	May 26-27 Eid al-Adha*
Dec. 26. - Jan. 1 Kwanzaa	June 19 Juneteenth
Feb. 17 Lunar New Year	
**Observance of Jewish and Muslim holidays begin at sundown on the first day listed and end at nightfall on the last date specified.*	

RESOLUTION No. 7052

Annual Multnomah Education Service District Local Service Plan Resolution

RECITALS

A. The 2025-26 Multnomah Education Service District ("MESD") Local Service Plan ("LSP") is essentially an annual menu of options offered to the MESD Superintendents' Council for the Council's review, modification, and approval.

B. The services offered in the LSP require approval of the component districts' boards annually. The Services offered in the LSP must be adopted by two-thirds of component districts' boards.

C. A separate list of the specific services for Portland Public Schools, or the District Service Plan, will be included in the 2025-26 budget development process.

D. The actual selection and use of resolution funds to pay for selected services remains at the discretion of each individual district. This Resolution does not commit Portland Public Schools to each of the specific services offered by MESD; it affirms the overall services offered to all of the local component districts and contains the terms of the LSP offered by the MESD.

RESOLUTION

1. The Board of Directors of Portland Public Schools, School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon, agrees to the conditions and provision of all programs and services, described in the 2025-26 Local Service Plan – Multnomah Education Service District with no exceptions.

2. In the event that the required resources are not available, each and every program and service is subject to reduction or elimination at the discretion of the Multnomah ESD Board. If such reductions or eliminations are necessary, they will be made through contingency planning in cooperation with the Superintendents of the local component districts.